Rebuild a live client site as a Next.js and Supabase site

How an existing client website becomes a new Next.js site built from the HGM template, matched section by section against the original. If you remember one thing: **the live site is the reference, not your memory** — every section is judged against a saved capture of the original, never against what looks about right on screen.

SOP ID	HGM-SOP-WEB-004	EFFECTIVE	2026-09-23
VERSION	0.6	NEXT REVIEW	2027-03-23
OWNER	Web & Content Specialist (Kyle Zinger)	TRIGGER	Every new AI website build request in Asana
APPROVED BY	Operations Manager (Gillian)	DURATION	3 to 5 working days (provisional)

01 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Purpose

Turns an existing client website into a new Next.js site built from the HGM AI website template, hosted on Netlify, with Supabase as the database and the client's property management system as the booking API. The finished site is a faithful copy of the original on its `netlify.app` address, ready for pre-launch checks.

In scope

Making the repository, connecting Netlify, collecting every key the build needs, gathering reference material, writing and executing the plan, matching every page and section to the original, building the forms and pop-up, checking the build works, and taking it through team, account manager and client review to approval.

Out of scope

Everything after client approval belongs to WEB-005: SEO and GEO, accessibility, Lighthouse, BrowserStack, legal pages, the money path, the test booking and the DNS cutover. Analytics and Search Console belong to WEB-003, after launch.

This SOP covers the case where a **live website already exists** and is being reproduced. Building a site from a Figma design with no live original is a separate SOP, not yet written.

ALWAYS TRUE

Five standing rules

True on every build.

1

The live site is the reference

Judge every section against a saved capture in `Resources/`, not against how it looks.

2

Never touch pricing or payment

Stop at the property page. The money path is WEB-005's job.

3

Secret keys live in two places

`.env.local` and the client's 1Password vault. Never in a commit, a prompt or a screenshot.

4

No custom domain

The site stays on its `*.netlify.app` address until the WEB-005 cutover.

5

Record what it cost

Every session adds a row to `TOKENS.md`.

02 PREREQUISITES

1 **Access to the hgmwebteam GitHub organisation**

Enough to create a repository from a private template. Ask the template owner if **Use this template** is not offered.

2 **The client's Netlify login**

Netlify is the client's own account, not HGM's. The credentials are on the client's record in hgmportal.com.

3 **Access to the client's GoHighLevel sub-account**

The site's forms are built there and embedded here. You need the sub-account, not the agency view.

4 **A login for hgmportal.com**

The portal holds the client record: which property management system they are on, and the keys HGM already has.

5 **1Password, with the client's vault**

Client logins and the site's `.env.local` entry live here. See HGM-SOP-WEB-001.

6 **VS Code with Claude Code signed in**

Every task in this SOP is done in VS Code, with Claude Code and the VS Code terminal. Node and npm installed — HGM-SOP-WEB-002 task 1.1 lists the four tools.

7 **The URL of the live site**

The site being reproduced. It must still be reachable; once DNS moves at launch it is gone.

8 **A browser with developer tools**

The original site's stylesheets and computed styles are where the design tokens come from. Chrome or Firefox, with the Elements and Network panels.

9 **The Asana task**

The build request. It carries the client, the deadline and anything the account manager has already agreed.

What are you trying to do?

Pick the phase that matches your situation and jump straight to its tasks.

PHASE 1

Start the site's repository

Tasks 1.1–1.4 · once, at the start of a build

PHASE 2

Connect the repository to Netlify

Tasks 2.1–2.3 · before any code is written

PHASE 3

Open the site on your machine

Tasks 3.1–3.4 · first time on this computer or site

PHASE 4

Collect the keys

Tasks 4.1–4.12 · as much as you can get today

PHASE 5

Build the Resources folder

Tasks 5.1–5.7 · before you write a line of the plan

PHASE 6

Write the plan

Tasks 6.1–6.4 · get a plan, not code

PHASE 7

Build it and match it

Tasks 7.1–7.13 · the long part of the job

PHASE 8

Review, approval and hand-on

Tasks 8.1–8.6 · team, account manager, client

Phase 1 — Start the site's repository

Pick the right template for the client's booking platform and make the site's own repository from it. Do this once, at the start of a build.

1.1 Find out which booking platform the client uses

Open **hgmportal.com**, find the client's record, and read which property management system they are on.

⚠ **Do not guess from the old site**

A WordPress site can front any booking platform, and some front more than one. The portal record is the answer. If the portal has no record, ask the account manager named on the Asana task before you start.

Image to be added

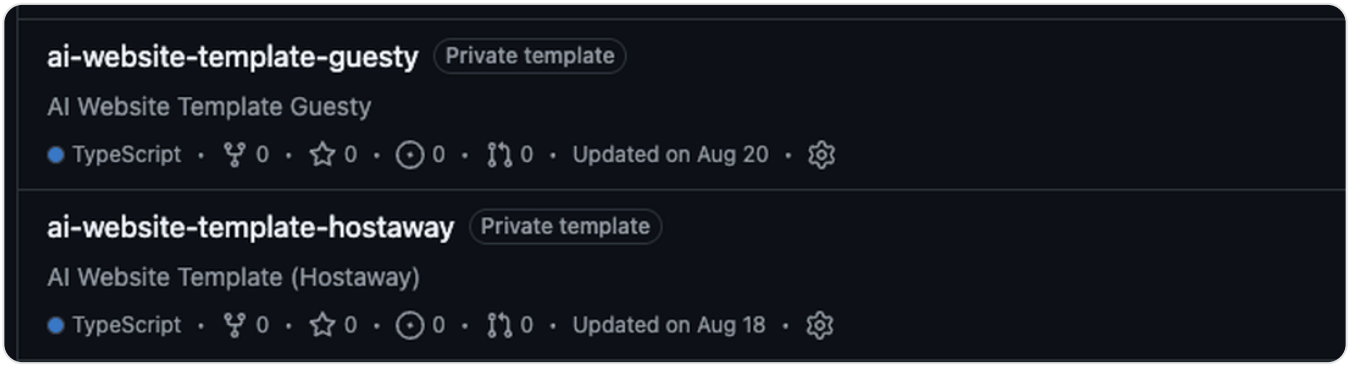
(image to be added) — The client's record on hgmportal.com, cropped to the property management system field. Ring the PMS field.

Expected result

You know the client is on Guesty or on Hostaway. Every later choice — template, plan, API keys — follows from this one.

1.2 Open the matching template repository

In GitHub, open the `hgmwebteam` organisation and open **ai-website-template-guesty** or **ai-website-template-hostaway**, whichever matches the answer from task 1.1.



The two site templates in the hgmwebteam organisation. Pick the one matching the client's booking platform.

No template for this booking platform

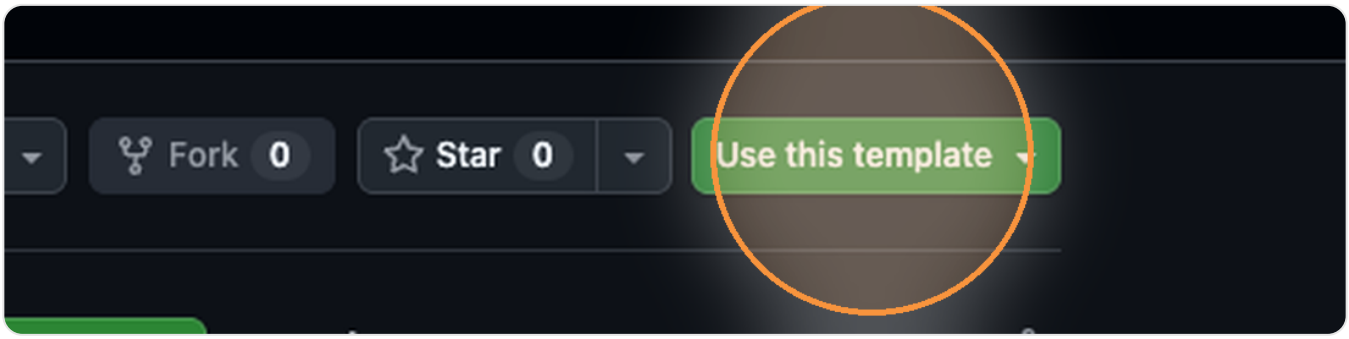
If the client is on a platform with no template — Cloudbeds, for example — start from **[NEEDS INPUT: the name of the standard AI website template repository in hgmwebteam]** or from whichever PMS template is closer, then tell Claude the platform is different in task 6.2. Do not start building against the wrong platform's booking engine.

Expected result

The repository page shows the **Private template** badge beside its name.

1.3 Create the site's repository from the template

Click **Use this template**, then **Create a new repository**. Set the owner to **hgmwebteam**, name it after the client in lower case with hyphens — for example `ridge-and-falls` — and set it to **Private**.



Use this template, at the top right of the template repository.

Why a template and not a fork

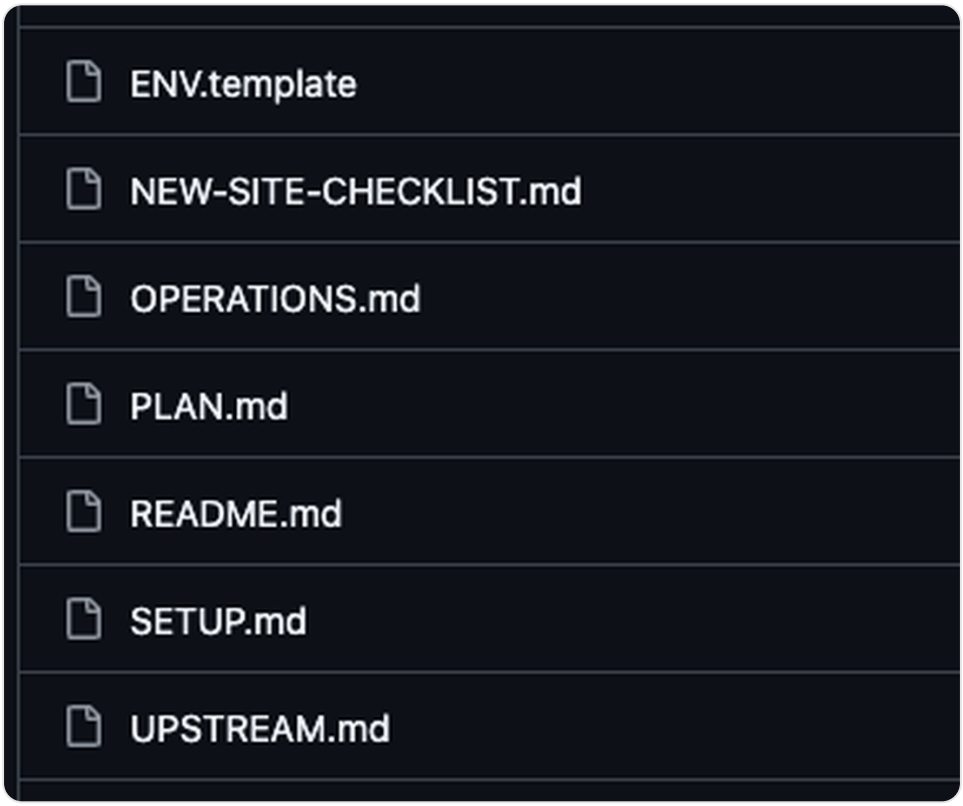
A fork keeps a link back to the template and carries its history. A template copy starts clean, which is what a client site wants — the template's own history is not this client's history.

Expected result

A new repository exists at `github.com/hgmwebteam/<client-name>` with the template's files and no commit history from the template.

1.4 Read the template's own documentation before touching anything

In the new repository, read `README.md`, `SETUP.md`, `NEW-SITE-CHECKLIST.md` and `UPSTREAM.md`. They describe this version of the template, which moves faster than this SOP does.



The template's documentation files, beside PLAN.md and ENV.template in the repository root.

Where the template and this SOP disagree, the template wins

The template is the running code. If `SETUP.md` contradicts a task here, follow `SETUP.md`, finish the build, then tell the Web & Content Specialist so this document gets fixed rather than quietly ignored.

Expected result

You know what the template already ships — booking engine, admin dashboard, checkout, email — so you do not rebuild something that is already there.

Phase 2 — Connect the repository to Netlify

Get HGM onto the client's Netlify account, then give the site a real address before any code is written — the address is itself a value the build needs.

2.1 Sign in to the client's Netlify account and add HGM to it

Sign in to Netlify with the client's credentials from their record on **hgmportal.com**. Go to **Team settings** → **Members**, invite the HGM web team Google account — the shared address on the same portal record — and give it the **Developer** role.

Developer, not Owner

Netlify's own guidance is to grant the least access that does the job. **Developer** covers everything this SOP needs. **Owner** additionally carries billing and the ability to delete the team, which is not HGM's to hold on a client account. If the client's plan only offers Owner, Collaborator and Billing Admin, choose **Collaborator**.

The account is the client's, permanently

The client pays for and owns the Netlify team. HGM is a member of it. That is what lets the relationship end without the site having to move.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — Netlify Team settings → Members with the invite dialog open and the role list showing. Ring the Developer option.

Expected result

The HGM web team account can reach the team, create projects, set environment variables and deploy, without being able to change billing or delete the team.

2.2 Import the repository into Netlify

In Netlify, click **Add new project**, then **Import an existing project**, then **GitHub**, then choose `hgmwebteam/<client-name>`. Accept the build settings the template supplies and click **Deploy**.

Connect the repository, do not create the site from the command line

A site created with the Netlify CLI has no Git connection, so nothing rebuilds when anyone pushes. Importing the repository is what makes every later push publish.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — Netlify Import an existing project → GitHub, with the repository list showing. Ring the repository row.

Expected result

A Netlify project exists and its first build starts. That build will fail, because no environment variables are set yet. That is expected and is fixed in task 4.11.

2.3 Record the site's address

Copy the project's `*.netlify.app` address from the Netlify project overview and paste it into the Asana task as a comment.

No custom domain in this SOP

Pointing the client's real domain at this project takes their current site down. The DNS cutover happens at launch, after the client has approved the build — see WEB-005.

Expected result

The team can reach the build without asking you, and you have the value task 4.5 needs.

Phase 3 — Open the site on your machine

Get your own copy running locally. If this is your first time on this computer, do the machine setup in HGM-SOP-WEB-002 first.

3.1 Clone the repository into VS Code

In a new VS Code window, open the Explorer and click **Clone Repository**, then paste the repository URL from GitHub's **Code** button.

The long version lives in WEB-002

HGM-SOP-WEB-002 tasks 1.1 to 1.7 cover installing the four tools, cloning and running `npm install`, with a screenshot on every click. Follow it the first time; come back here once the repository is open.

OR CLONE FROM THE TERMINAL

```
git clone https://github.com/hgmwebteam/<client-name>.git
cd <client-name>
```

Expected result

VS Code asks where to save it, then asks whether to open it. Open it.

3.2 Install the packages

Open a terminal in the project folder and run `npm install`.

IN THE PROJECT FOLDER

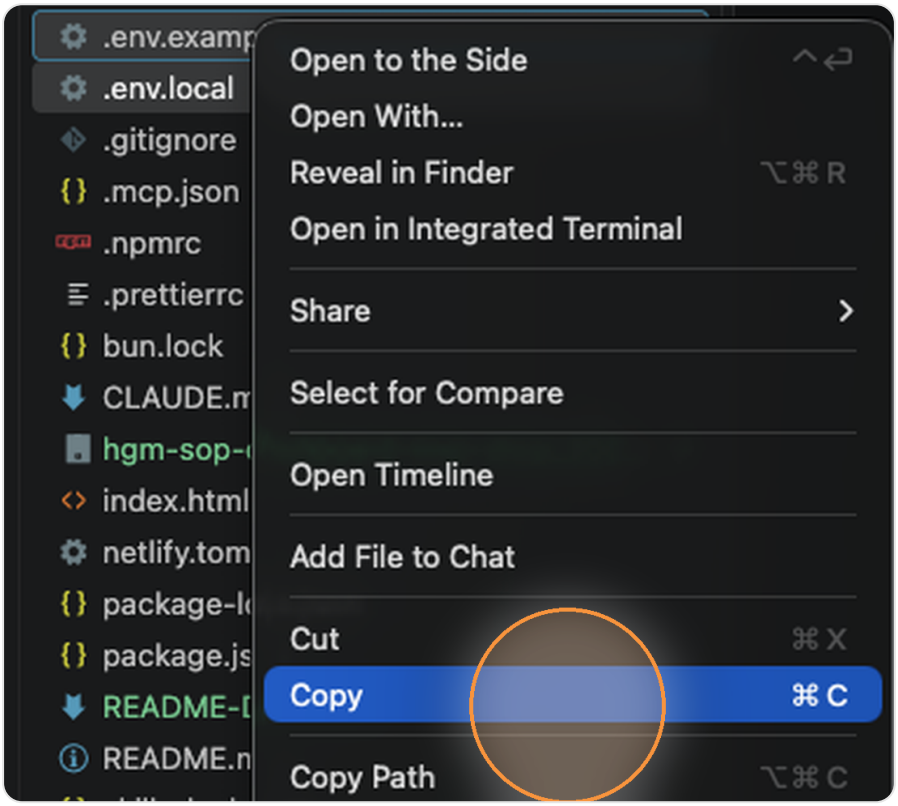
```
npm install
```

Expected result

The command finishes without an error and a `node_modules` folder appears. It takes a few minutes the first time.

3.3 Make your own environment file

In the Explorer, right-click the template's environment example file in the repository root — `ENV.template` in the current templates — choose **Copy**, then **Paste**, and rename the copy to `.env.local`.



Right-click the environment example file and choose Copy. The same menu carries Copy Relative Path, used later when a prompt needs an exact file path.

Do not put NETLIFY_SITE_ID in .env.local

Setting it locally flips the site into its deployed-Netlify behaviour while you are on `localhost`: images start requesting Netlify's image CDN and 404, and the local booking store points at the deployed site's storage. Leave it unset locally and set it on Netlify only.

Expected result

`.env.local` sits in the repository root and is greyed out in the Explorer, because `.gitignore` excludes it. If it is not greyed out, stop and check `.gitignore` before you put a key in it.

3.4 Start the cost file

Create `TOKENS.md` in the repository root with one heading and a table — date, session, approximate tokens, cost in Canadian dollars — and commit it.

CREATE AND COMMIT THE FILE

```
printf '# Token spend\n\n| Date | Session | Approx. tokens | Cost (CAD) |\n|---|---|---|---|\n' > TOKENS.md
git add TOKENS.md && git commit -m "chore: start token spend log"
```

Expected result

Every later session has somewhere to record what it cost. Task 8.1 fills in a row.

Phase 4 — Collect the keys

Fill in as much of the environment file as you can get today, set the same values on Netlify, and write the result back to 1Password.

4.1 Take the keys HGM already holds from the portal

Open **hgmportal.com**, open the client's record, and copy every key it holds for this client into `.env.local`, matching each one to the variable name in `ENV.template`.

Some values are the same for every client

A small number of platform credentials are held once at the agency and reused — the portal record is where you find out which. Never copy one from another client's `.env.local`; take it from the portal.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The keys section of the client's record on hgmportal.com, with every value redacted before you send it.

Expected result

The variables HGM can supply without the client are filled in.

4.2 Get into the client's Supabase project and add yourself to it

Sign in to Supabase with the client's credentials from 1Password, open their project, then invite your own HGM account as a member under **Project settings** → **Members**.

The client owns this project

The Supabase project is created in the client's own account, not HGM's. Adding yourself as a member is what keeps the audit trail honest and survives a password change on their side.

Image to be added

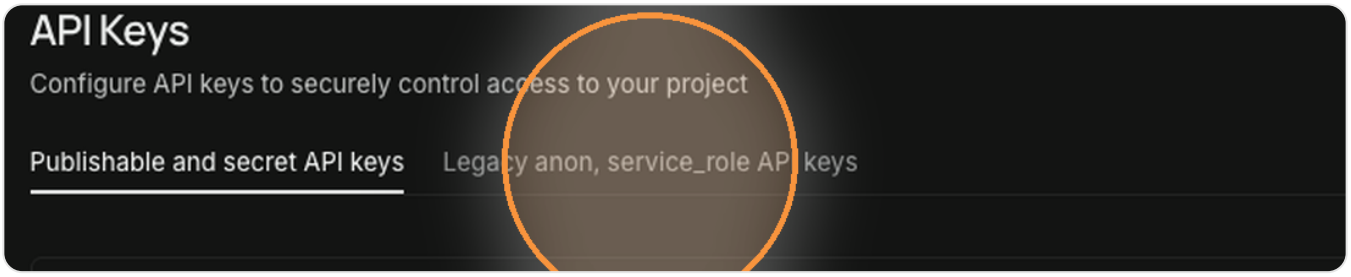
(image to be added) — Supabase Project settings → Members with the invite dialog open. Ring the Invite button.

Expected result

You can reach the project signed in as yourself, and you stop using the client's login from this point on.

4.3 Open the project's API keys

In the Supabase project, go to **Project settings** → **API Keys**, then click the **Legacy anon, service_role API keys** tab.



The API Keys page. Click the Legacy anon, service_role API keys tab — the first tab shows the newer key pair, which the template does not use.

Expected result

The tab shows an `anon` key and a `service_role` key. The template expects these two, not the newer publishable and secret pair on the first tab.

4.4 Copy the two Supabase values into the environment file

Copy the project URL and the `anon` key into their `NEXT_PUBLIC_` variables, and the `service_role` key into its own variable, exactly as `ENV.template` names them.

The service role key is a master key

It ignores row level security and can read and write every row in the client's database. It must never sit in a variable whose name starts `NEXT_PUBLIC_`, never be committed, and never appear in a screenshot. If one is ever exposed, rotate it in Supabase the same day and tell the template owner.

Expected result

Three Supabase values are set and nothing has been pasted into a chat window.

4.5 Set the site's own address

Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` to the `*.netlify.app` address you recorded in task 2.3, with no trailing slash.

Expected result

The variable is set. Leaving it empty makes the site throw during the build rather than falling back to a default.

4.6 Get the Stripe test keys and a 100% coupon from the client

Through the account manager, ask the client for the test publishable key and test secret key from their Stripe account, or sandbox details, plus a 100% coupon for the WEB-005 test booking. **[NEEDS INPUT: Q11 — whether Stripe is the client's own account and who swaps test for live]**

MESSAGE FOR THE ACCOUNT MANAGER TO FORWARD

For <client>'s new site we need Stripe test access so we can prove the payment path without charging anyone: the test publishable key and test secret key from their Stripe dashboard (test mode), or sandbox login details, plus a 100% coupon code for one test booking. Please send them through 1Password, not email.

Test keys only

A key beginning `sk_live_` never goes into `.env.local`. If the client sends live keys, put them in 1Password and stop; the live swap happens in WEB-005.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — Stripe's test-mode API keys screen, both values redacted before you send it. Ring the test-mode toggle.

Expected result

Two keys beginning `pk_test_` and `sk_test_`, and a coupon code, in the client's 1Password vault.

4.7 Get the Resend API key

[NEEDS INPUT: Q13 — whether Resend is the client's account or HGM's, and where the key is created]

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The Resend API keys screen, value redacted.

Expected result

A Resend API key in `.env.local` under **[NEEDS INPUT: the variable name in ENV.template]**.

4.8 Get the Meta pixel ID and access token

[NEEDS INPUT: Q19 — where the shared HGM conversions API token is kept, and whether the pixel ID is per client]

Expected result

Both values in `.env.local`.

4.9 Get the GoHighLevel Location ID and private integration token

In the client's GoHighLevel sub-account, open the business profile and copy the Location ID. Then create a new private integration and copy its token. **[NEEDS INPUT: Q16 — which scopes to select, and the menu labels in HGM's white-labelled GoHighLevel]**

Check which sub-account you are in

A token from the wrong sub-account sends this client's enquiries and bookings into another client's CRM, and nothing errors.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The GoHighLevel private integration screen after creation, with the scope list showing. Ring the scope list.

Expected result

The Location ID matches the one on the client's record in hgmportal.com, and both values are in `.env.local`.

4.10 Get the booking platform's booking engine details

For Guesty: open **Marketing + Sales** → **Distribution** → **Guesty Booking Engine** and copy the booking engine API (BEAPI) URL. **[NEEDS INPUT: Q17 — the variable it fills, and the Hostaway and Cloudbeds equivalents]**

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The booking platform's distribution screen where the booking engine URL is shown. Ring the URL field.

Expected result

The booking platform values are in `.env.local`.

4.11 Put the variables on Netlify and rebuild

Ask Claude Code to set each variable from `.env.local` on the Netlify project, one at a time, then trigger a new deploy. If Claude cannot reach Netlify, add them by hand in **Site configuration** → **Environment variables**.

CLAUDE PROMPT — NEEDS THE NETLIFY CLI LOGGED IN AND LINKED

```
Using the Netlify CLI on the project linked to this repository, set each variable that has a value
in .env.local and also appears in ENV.template, one at a time with netlify env:set. Skip NETLIFY_SITE_ID.
Never use netlify env:import, never print a value, and list the variable names you set. If the CLI is not
logged in or the site is not linked, stop and tell me.
```

Named variables only, never a bulk import

Importing `.env.local` whole uploads anything personal to your machine and arms every scheduled function the template ships. The prompt sets only names that are in `ENV.template`.

First run of the automated route

This replaces typing each variable in by hand. Check the list Claude prints against Netlify on the first build that uses it, and tell the Web & Content Specialist if anything was missed.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — Netlify Site configuration → Environment variables, mid-way through adding one, values redacted. Ring the Add a variable button.

Expected result

The deploy succeeds and the `netlify.app` address serves the template's home page.

4.12 Write the environment file back to 1Password

Save the current `.env.local` into the client's 1Password vault following HGM-SOP-WEB-001. Leave a key blank if the client has not supplied it yet; the blank is the record of what is still owed.

Deferring a key is normal

Some keys are not needed until launch, and some clients are slow to supply them. Build without them and fill them in when they arrive — WEB-005 checks for blanks before anything goes live.

Expected result

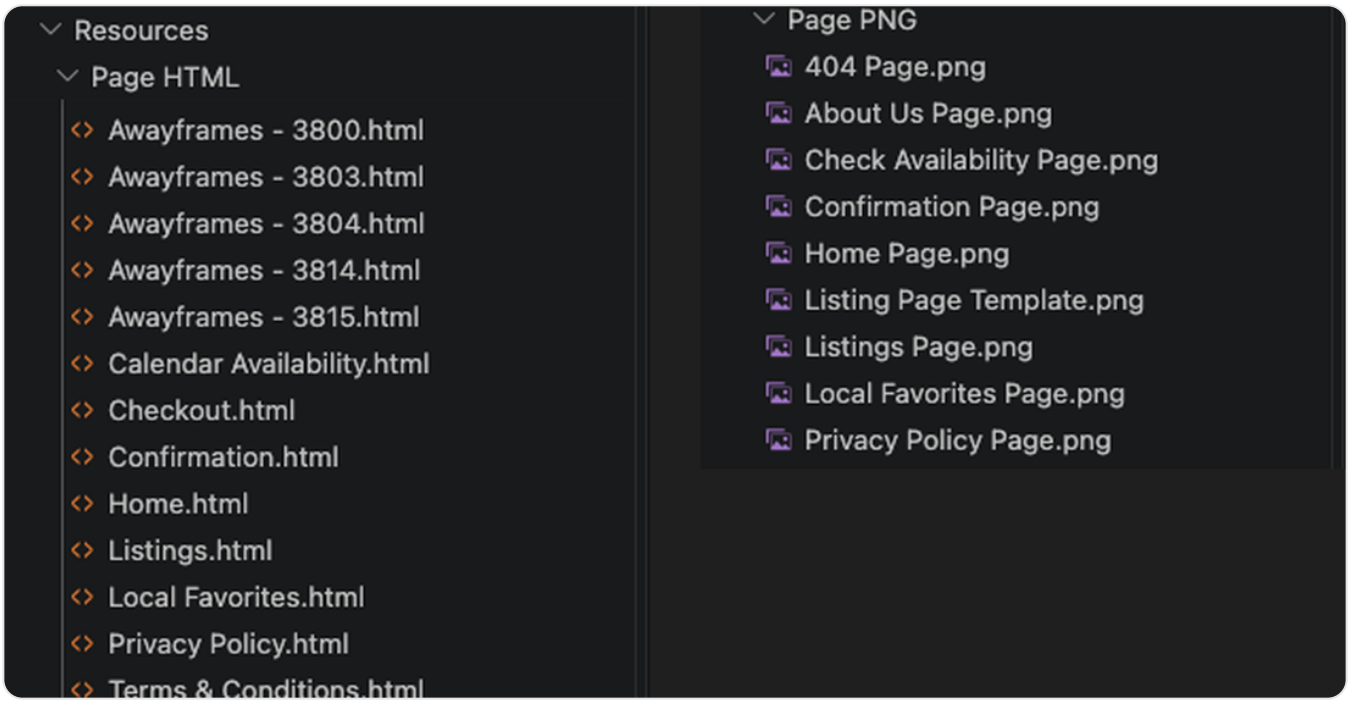
Someone else could pick the build up tomorrow from 1Password alone, and WEB-005 task 1.3 finds the missing keys by their blank values.

Phase 5 — Build the Resources folder

Gather the evidence the build gets checked against. Doing this properly is what makes phase 7 finite.

5.1 Create the folder structure

In the repository root, create `Resources/` containing `Page HTML/`, `Page PNG/`, `Design System/` and `CSS/`.



Resources/Page HTML and Resources/Page PNG on a finished build — one file per page of the original site, named for the page.

Expected result

Four empty folders, committed to the repository. They stay there — the evidence lives with the code.

5.2 Save the HTML of every page on the original site

For each page in the original site's sitemap, save the rendered page source into `Resources/Page HTML/`, named for the page — `Home.html`, `Listings.html`, `Checkout.html` and so on.

ONE PAGE, FROM THE TERMINAL

```
curl -sL "https://<live-site>/<page>" -o "Resources/Page HTML/<Page>.html"
```

Expected result

One HTML file per page. This is the copy that carries exact wording, field names and widget settings, which a screenshot cannot.

5.3 Capture every page as a full-page image

Capture each page of the original site top to bottom at 2× pixel density with a full-page capture extension — the team uses FireShot — and save it into `Resources/Page PNG/`, named for the page.

Keep anything you attach to a prompt under 2000px wide

Claude handles an attached image poorly once it is wider than about 2000 pixels — it reads the picture but stops seeing the detail you are asking about. Capture at 2× for the archive, then resize the copy you attach so its longest edge is 2000 pixels or less.

Expected result

One image per page, showing the whole page rather than the visible window.

5.4 Capture each section, the header and the footer separately

Capture every distinct section of the original — hero, search widget, listing grid, reviews, calls to action — plus the header and footer, at 2×, and save them into `Resources/Design System/`.

Expected result

A section-level library. Phase 7 attaches one of these per correction prompt, and a section capture is readable where a full-page capture is not.

5.5 Save the original site's stylesheets

Open the original site with the browser's **Network** panel filtered to CSS, reload, and save every stylesheet the page loads into `Resources/CSS/` under its own filename.

Where the values actually live

On a WordPress and Elementor site the global kit stylesheet holds the whole palette as literal hex values, plus the type scale. On a modern build it is usually a block of CSS custom properties near the top of the main stylesheet. Either way it is machine-readable, which a capture is not.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The browser's Network panel filtered to CSS on the original site, showing the stylesheet list. Ring the filter control.

Expected result

The site's real design values are now on disk as text. This is the exact source — a screenshot is an approximation of it.

5.6 Build the variables file from the stylesheets

In Claude Code, run the prompt below against `Resources/CSS/`. Save the result as `Resources/VARIABLES.md`.

BUILD THE VARIABLES FILE

```
Read every stylesheet in Resources/CSS/ and write Resources/VARIABLES.md.

List the design tokens this site actually uses: colour ramps and semantic colours as hex, font families, font weights, the font-size scale, line heights, the spacing scale, border radii, shadows and breakpoints.

For every value, give the file and the declaration it came from. Where one role carries more than one value across the site, list them all and say which pages use which.

Do not infer a value you cannot point at in the CSS. List it under "Unresolved" instead, with what you were looking for.
```

Build it from the CSS, not from the captures

Asking for tokens from screenshots produces plausible hexes that are one or two shades out, and nobody catches it until the client does. The stylesheet carries the real numbers. Use the captures to check the file, not to write it.

Expected result

A Markdown file listing the site's colours, fonts, sizes, spacing, radii and breakpoints, each traceable to the declaration it came from, and each value you cannot trace listed as unresolved rather than filled in.

5.7 Check the variables against the rendered page, then commit

Open three pages of the original in the browser. On each, use **Inspect** → **Computed** on the main heading, a paragraph of body text and the primary button, and compare the font, size, weight, colour and radius against `VARIABLES.md`. Correct the file where they differ, then commit the whole `Resources/` folder.

Where the file and the page disagree, the page wins

A stylesheet can carry declarations that something later overrides, so the computed value is the truth. Fix `VARIABLES.md` to match what renders, and note the override in the file so nobody re-introduces the dead value.

Capture the states a screenshot misses

While you are in the browser, capture the hover states, the open mobile menu, a form with a validation error showing, and any empty or sold-out state. Save them into `Resources/Design System/`. These are the details phase 7 is most likely to get wrong, because nothing in a static capture shows them.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — Devtools with Computed open on a heading, with font, size and colour visible.

Expected result

Every value you spot-checked matches what the browser actually renders, and everything the build will be judged against is pushed rather than sitting in one person's Downloads folder.

Phase 6 — Write the plan

Rework the template's plan for this client, read it yourself, and only then let anything be built.

6.1 Replace the template's placeholder client everywhere

Open `PLAN.md` and run find and replace across the file: the placeholder client name the template ships with, replaced by this client's name.

> **This is the most common mistake in the whole build**
>
> A leftover client name in the plan gets built into the site — wrong phone number, wrong branding, wrong copy — and it is found weeks later by the client. Check the whole file, not just the headings.

> **Expected result**
>
> No other client's name survives anywhere in `PLAN.md`. Search the file for the old name afterwards and confirm zero results.

6.2 Replace the property management system throughout

In the same file, replace every mention of the template's booking platform with the one this client uses. If the client's platform has no template, also run the prompt below before task 6.3.

CLAUDE PROMPT — ONLY WHEN THE PLATFORM HAS NO TEMPLATE

```
This client is on <booking platform>, not <template's platform>. Its booking engine, API, listings, availability and reservation model are different. Research how <booking platform>'s API and booking engine work, then update plan.md so every section that touches booking, listings, availability or checkout is written for <booking platform>. List what you changed and anything you could not confirm.
```

> **Expected result**
>
> `PLAN.md` names one booking platform, it is the client's, and the booking sections are written for it.

6.3 Ask Claude to rewrite the plan against this project

In Claude Code, with the repository open, paste the prompt below with the four values filled in.

REWORK THE PLAN

FILL IN THE FOUR ANGLE-BRACKET VALUES

```
Go through plan.md and update all the sections to reflect creating the website using the template which we defined at the top of the file. The website will be created and will be hosted on Netlify. The database will be Supabase, and the API will be <Guesty or Hostaway>. We are recreating the <live site URL> website, which was built using <WordPress/Elementor, or whatever the original was built in>, as a Next.js site. The plan should highlight in detail, with the same sections that are already in place, reproducing the website using the current plan. Update what is necessary.
```

Point the plan at the evidence

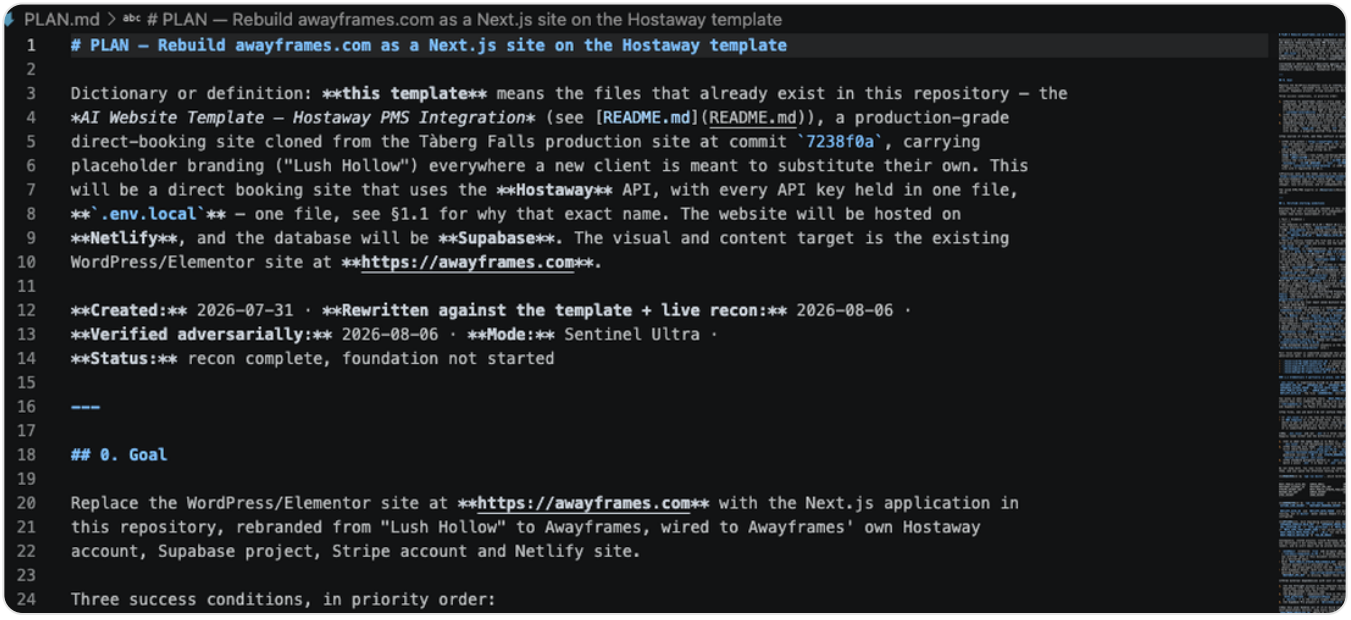
Add a line naming `Resources/` as the reference set — the saved HTML, the captures and `VARIABLES.md` — so the plan is written against what is on disk rather than against the live site the model cannot see.

Expected result

`PLAN.md` now describes this client's build section by section, against this template, with the original site named as the target.

6.4 Read the plan yourself before executing it

Read `PLAN.md` end to end. Check the goal names the right site, the success conditions are ones you could test, every page in the original's sitemap appears, and any page deliberately left out is named as such.



The top of a reworked PLAN.md — it names the template, the original site, the host, the database, the booking API, and the success conditions in priority order.

Nothing is built until the plan is right

Executing a wrong plan costs a day and a large share of the build's token budget, and the result looks finished enough that the error survives review. Reading the plan takes fifteen minutes.

Expected result

You could explain to Gillian what is being built and what is deliberately not. If you cannot, fix the plan before task 7.1.

Phase 7 — Build it and match it

Execute the plan, then close the gap between your copy and the original, section by section. This is where most of the elapsed time goes.

7.1 Execute the plan

In Claude Code, on a branch off `main`, run the prompt below and let it work through `PLAN.md`.

EXECUTE THE PLAN

```
Execute Plan.md, ensure there are no mistakes. Everything must be perfect.
```

Expected result

The site runs on `localhost` with every page in the plan present. It will not yet match the original.

7.2 Close the obvious gap against the original

Run the prompt below with the original site's URL. Use it once, to get from roughly right to close.

MATCH THE ORIGINAL — DROP THE LAST LINE IF SENTINEL MODES ARE NOT SET UP

```
The website does not look exactly the same, create a loop and loop until everything looks exactly like
<live site URL>. There can be no mistakes, everything must be perfect.

Use Sentinel Ultra and Sentinel.
```

A loop is a blunt instrument

Looping against a whole site gets you close and then stops improving, while spending tokens on every pass. Run it once, then switch to task 7.3. Looping a second time is the single easiest way to waste a day.

Expected result

Structure, page order and the large layout decisions now follow the original. Fine detail will not, and that is task 7.3's job.

7.3 Correct the site section by section, in one pass

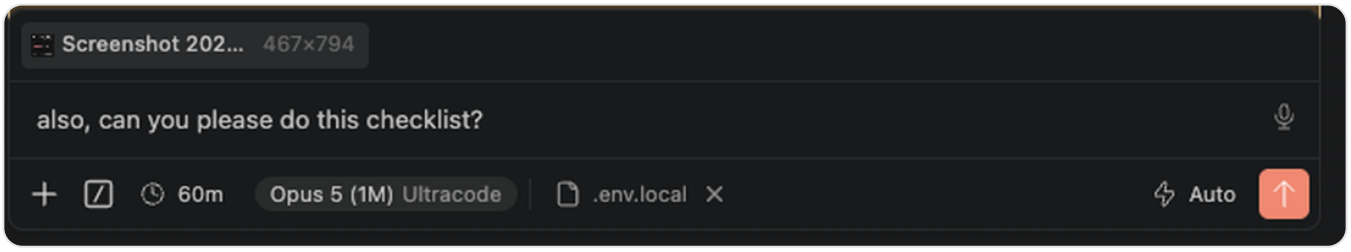
Open the original and your local site side by side. Write one prompt that names every section that is wrong, says what is wrong with each, and attaches the matching capture from `Resources/Design System/` plus a capture of your version.

A REAL CORRECTION PASS — ONE PROMPT, SEVERAL NUMBERED CORRECTIONS

```
1) Edit the listings page's Quick tour section to remove the gallery button on every image and just have each image link to the gallery.
2) Can we go three wide here, not four? It is too squished.
3) Wrong phone number – it should be the same phone number as the rest of the site.
4) Reduce the height of this pop-up card by shrinking the height of the image on the right and removing the large amount of spacing on the left between the form and the title and the bottom of the area. Snug the text up to near the bottom of the form if possible. Good UX/UI please.
```

One large prompt beats a loop

Addressing every section in a single well-written prompt has consistently produced better results than asking for a loop. Be specific about what is wrong; "make it match" produces a rewrite, and a rewrite breaks the sections that were already right.



The Claude Code prompt box in VS Code — the attached capture sits above the prompt as a chip, and the file in context sits on the toolbar beside the model.

Resize before you attach

Attach nothing wider than 2000 pixels. An oversized capture is read as a picture rather than as evidence, and the correction comes back generic.

Expected result

Each section moves towards the original in one round rather than several. Re-capture your site and repeat until the list is empty.

7.4 Build the form in GoHighLevel

Open the client's GoHighLevel sub-account, go to **Sites** → **Forms**, start from the HGM form template, and adjust the fields to match the form on the original site.

Check which sub-account you are in

A form built in the wrong sub-account sends one client's enquiries into another client's CRM, and nothing errors — the submission simply lands in the wrong place. Confirm the location before you build, and confirm the Location ID on the client's record in hgmportal.com matches the one you are working in.

Labels can differ

HGM's GoHighLevel is white-labelled, so a menu may not read exactly as it does in GoHighLevel's own documentation. Follow the equivalent item rather than looking for the literal words.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — GoHighLevel Sites → Forms with the HGM form template in the list. Ring the template row.

Expected result

A saved form in the client's own sub-account, with the same fields the original site asked for and no extras.

7.5 Copy the form's embed code

In the form builder, click **Integrate form**, choose **Inline** as the embed type, and copy the embed code.

> **Take the inline embed even for the pop-up**
>
> The inline embed drops into a container you control, which is what the site's own pop-up needs. GoHighLevel's own pop-up embed brings its own overlay and fights the one built in task 7.7.

> **Image to be added**
>
> **(image to be added)** — The GoHighLevel form builder with the integrate control visible, then the embed dialog with the inline layout selected. Ring the Integrate form control.

> **Expected result**
>
> An `iframe` snippet on your clipboard, pointing at the form you just built.

7.6 Place the forms on the site

Give Claude the embed code and say where each form goes — inline in a named page, or inside the pop-up.

> **The form is not ours to restyle**
>
> Fields, validation and where a submission lands are configured in GoHighLevel, inside the iframe. Everything built here is the container around the embed.

> **Submit one of each before you move on**
>
> Send a test submission through every form on the site and confirm it appears as a contact in the client's GoHighLevel sub-account. A form that renders and does not deliver looks identical to one that works.

> **Expected result**
>
> Each form renders in place, sized to its container, on desktop and on a phone.

7.7 Build the pop-up

Attach the pop-up captures from `Resources/Design System/` and ask for the same design at every screen size, with the offer wording taken from the Asana task.

POP-UP — REPLACE THE OFFER WITH THE ONE ON THE ASANA TASK

```
Build the pop-up to match the attached design. Keep a similar design on all screen sizes but allow different content where the layout needs it. The offer is 10% off, not a fixed dollar amount.
```

Check the offer against the task, not the design file

Offer wording changes after a design is signed off more often than the design gets updated. A percentage and a dollar amount are not interchangeable, and the wrong one is a discount HGM has published on the client's behalf.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The finished pop-up on a phone width and on a desktop width, side by side.

Expected result

One pop-up design, correct on a phone and on a desktop, showing the offer the client actually agreed.

7.8 Agree the mobile menu before building it

The original site's mobile menu is rarely in the design and rarely worth copying. Post a capture of the original's mobile menu in the **client websites** space in Google Chat, propose what you intend to build, and get a reply before building it.

POST IN THE CLIENT WEBSITES SPACE

<client> mobile menu — the original uses <describe it>. I am proposing <what you intend to build> instead, because <reason>. Shout before end of day if you would rather I copied the original exactly.

Expected result

A written decision from the designer or the account manager. Build that.

7.9 Add the motion

Ask for the site's animations in one pass, naming the motion skill so the result is consistent rather than improvised per section.

ANIMATIONS

```
Add an immersive experience by applying the appropriate animations to all the pages – for example elements fading in – using the /emil-design-eng skill.
```

Install the skill first

The `/emil-design-eng` command only works if the skill is installed in your Claude Code. Install it from **[NEEDS INPUT: where the team gets the emil-design-eng skill]** before you run the prompt.

Expected result

Elements enter and transition consistently across every page, and nothing moves for a visitor who has reduced motion turned on.

7.10 Ask Claude to check the build works like the original

Run the prompt below. It checks function, not looks — including the parts you cannot see.

CLAUDE PROMPT — PASTE INTO CLAUDE CODE

```
Compare this build with <live site URL> for function, not appearance. Check every page loads, every link and button goes where the original's does, every form submits, listings and their images load from Supabase and the booking platform, the search widget returns results, and nothing in the browser console errors. Fix what is broken, then list what you checked, what you fixed and anything you could not check.
```

Expected result

A list of what works, what does not and what was fixed. Treat it as a first pass; task 7.11 is the check that counts.

7.11 Check it yourself: every page, every button

Open the build on `localhost`. Go to every page in the sitemap and click every link, button, menu and form. Try to break it. Write down anything that fails and give the list to Claude in one prompt, as in task 7.3.

Expected result

Every page opens, every control does something, and nothing on your list is still broken.

7.12 Walk the booking flow as a guest

Start at the search widget on the home page. Choose dates, guests and pets if the site asks, and search. On the stays page, check the widget shows what you chose. Open a property and check its listing page shows the same dates and guests, so the guest never chooses them twice.

Stop at the property page

Prices, deposits, checkout, coupons and anything that creates a charge are not built or altered in this SOP. That work is done in the pre-launch SOP, in Claude Fable, against a test key. A mistake past this line charges a real person the wrong amount.

Image to be added

(image to be added) — The finished build's search widget with dates and guests filled in, and the property page it leads to.

Expected result

A guest can get from the home page to a property page with their dates intact. Stop there.

7.13 Check the original site has not changed during the build

Run the prompt below against the original.

CLAUDE PROMPT — PASTE INTO CLAUDE CODE

```
Compare <live site URL> today with the captures in Resources/Page HTML and Resources/Page PNG. List every page whose content, layout or wording has changed since they were saved. Make no changes to the build.
```

Expected result

Either nothing changed, or the changed pages are re-captured into `Resources/` and rebuilt.

Phase 8 — Review, approval and hand-on

Record what the build cost, get it reviewed by the team, and pass it to pre-launch.

8.1 Record what the build cost

In Claude Code, ask for the approximate token count for the work, convert it to Canadian dollars, and append a row to `TOKENS.md`.

TOKEN COUNT

```
Give me the approximate tokens used from the start of this project to now, then convert those tokens to USD and then to CAD at today's rate. Append the result as a row in TOKENS.md with today's date.
```

Why this is worth the two minutes

The long-term aim is a defensible cost per build, and the input to that is a per-session figure recorded while the session is still in memory. Reconstructing it afterwards is guesswork.

Expected result

`TOKENS.md` has a row per session and a running total. Operations can see the real cost of a build rather than an estimate.

8.2 Push the branch and open a pull request

Push your branch and open a pull request against `main`, following HGM-SOP-WEB-002 phase 5.

Expected result

Netlify builds a deploy preview and posts its link on the pull request.

8.3 Post the site for team review

Post the deploy preview link in the **client websites** space in Google Chat and ask the team to review it for mistakes and issues.

POST IN THE CLIENT WEBSITES SPACE

```
<client> rebuild is ready for a look: <deploy preview URL>
```

Original for comparison: <live site URL>

Looking for anything that does not match the original, on desktop and on a phone. Known gaps: <list them>. Comments by <date> please — it moves to pre-launch checks after that.

Expected result

The team has the link and a deadline. Work through what comes back, then merge the pull request so the `netlify.app` address carries it.

8.4 Send the site to the account manager

Once the team's comments are fixed and merged, post the `netlify.app` address in the **client websites** space for the account manager and ask them to review it before the client sees it.

POST IN THE CLIENT WEBSITES SPACE

@<account manager> <client>'s new site is ready for your review before it goes to the client: <netlify.app URL>. Original for comparison: <live site URL>. Reply here with anything to change, or a go-ahead to send it on.

Expected result

The account manager has the link and replies with changes or a go-ahead to send it to the client.

8.5 Work through the client's revisions

The account manager sends the site to the client. Make each change they ask for through the HGM-SOP-WEB-002 branch-and-preview path, until the client has no open comments.

Expected result

Every revision is merged and the `netlify.app` address shows it.

8.6 Confirm the client has approved, then hand on

When the account manager confirms the client has approved the site, post in the **client websites** space that the build is moving to pre-launch, with the `netlify.app` address and the `TOKENS.md` total.

POST IN THE CLIENT WEBSITES SPACE

<client> is approved by the client and moving to pre-launch (WEB-005): <netlify.app URL>. Build cost so far: <TOKENS.md total>.

No approval, no pre-launch

WEB-005 starts only after the client has approved the site and every revision is done.

Expected result

The build is approved and somebody else could take it to launch without asking you a question. Continue in WEB-005.

04 EXCEPTIONS AND EDGE CASES

A page in the original is deliberately not being rebuilt

Name it in `PLAN.md` as out of scope and say what happens to its URL instead — usually a redirect. An unlisted omission is indistinguishable from a page somebody forgot.

If you are stuck

Ask Claude first, with the error and the task number. If the template itself is wrong, stale or missing a file, tell Leshan Patterson, template owner, in the **client websites** space in Google Chat. If the build is going to take longer than the request assumed, tell Gillian, Operations Manager, in Google Chat in phase 5 — when you can see how big the original is — not in phase 7.

05 FINAL CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU HAND THE BUILD ON

- [ ] Every page in the original site's sitemap exists on the build, or is named in `PLAN.md` as out of scope with its redirect.
- [ ] No other client's name appears anywhere in the repository — search the whole project, not just `PLAN.md`.
- [ ] `Resources/` is committed and holds the saved HTML, the page captures, the section captures, the stylesheets and `VARIABLES.md`.
- [ ] Every colour, font and size on the build traces to a value in `VARIABLES.md`, and nothing in that file is still marked unresolved.
- [ ] `.env.local` is not committed, and its current contents are saved in the client's 1Password vault.

- [ ] Every variable on Netlify matches the one in `.env.local`, and the production deploy succeeds.
- [ ] A test submission from every form has appeared as a contact in the client's GoHighLevel sub-account.
- [ ] The HGM web team account is a member of the client's Netlify team, and the client is still its Owner.
- [ ] The booking flow runs from the home page search to a property page with dates carried through.
- [ ] Nothing in the pricing or payment path has been altered.
- [ ] The site is on its `netlify.app` address and no DNS record has been changed.
- [ ] `TOKENS.md` has a row for every session and a total.
- [ ] `.env.local` is saved to the client's 1Password vault, with a blank for every key still owed.
- [ ] Claude's function check (7.10) and your own every-page check (7.11) are done, and nothing on either list is open.
- [ ] The team, then the account manager, then the client have reviewed the site; every revision is merged and the client has approved.

Next: pre-launch readiness checks

HGM-SOP-WEB-005 — SEO and GEO, accessibility to WCAG 2.2 AA, the Lighthouse loop, BrowserStack, legal pages, the pixels, the Stripe and webhook work, the test booking and the DNS cutover. Starts once the client has approved the site.

Then: post-launch connections

HGM-SOP-WEB-003 — Google Analytics 4, Search Console, Hotjar, the structured-data check and the ownership map at handover. Starts the day the site is live.

06 RELATED DOCUMENTS

This SOP is the middle of three. It ends where the site is complete on its temporary address; the next document takes it to launch, and the one after that picks it up once it is live.

DOCUMENT	COVERS	WHEN
HGM-SOP-WEB-004 — this document	Rebuilding a live client site as a Next.js and Supabase site	From the build request to a finished site on `netlify.app`
HGM-SOP-WEB-005 — pre-launch readiness checks	SEO, GEO, accessibility, Lighthouse, BrowserStack, legal pages, pixels, Stripe and webhooks, the test booking, DNS cutover	Once the client has approved the build at task 8.6
HGM-SOP-WEB-003 — post-launch connections	GA4, Search Console, Hotjar, structured data, the ownership map	Launch week, after the DNS cutover
HGM-SOP-WEB-002 — Asana to live	Machine setup, branches, pull requests, deploy previews, merging	Referenced from tasks 3.1, 8.2 and 8.5. Read it first if you have never set this machine up
HGM-SOP-WEB-001 — env files in 1Password	Storing, sharing and updating a client's `.env` file	Referenced from tasks 4.12 and the prerequisites
Building a site from a Figma design	The same build with a design file and no live original as the reference	Not yet written. Raise it with the Web & Content Specialist when a project needs it

The build is not finished when the site looks right

A site that matches the original and has never been through the pre-launch checks is not ready for a client, let alone a domain. Task 8.6 hands it on; do not treat a merged pull request as the end of the job.

07 REVISION HISTORY

DATE	VERSION	AUTHOR	CHANGE
2026-09-22	0.1	Kyle Zinger	First working draft from build notes and screenshots. Launch checks split out to a planned WEB-005.
2026-09-23	0.2	Kyle Zinger	Netlify is the client's account, with HGM added as a Developer (new task 2.1). New tasks 7.4 to 7.6 build the GoHighLevel form and take its embed code.
2026-09-23	0.3	Kyle Zinger	Figure added to task 7.3 — the Claude Code prompt box with an attached capture.
2026-09-23	0.4	Kyle Zinger	Figma removed from the procedure — it belongs to the design-to-site SOP. Design tokens now come from the original site's own stylesheets (tasks 5.5 to 5.7).
2026-10-06	0.5	Kyle Zinger	Twelve image placeholders added at the tasks that still need a capture, ahead of the portal upload.
2026-10-09	0.6	Kyle Zinger	Loom review with AnhTuan. Roles, definitions, troubleshooting and the platform choice removed; VS Code only. Where every key comes from (4.6–4.10). Function checks, a changed-original check, and account manager and client review before hand-on (7.10–8.7).

REMEMBER

"A copy is judged against the original, not against how good it looks on its own."

Next

HGM-SOP-WEB-005 — pre-launch checks